around the table, now persuade themselves instead that "toughness pays." If there was risk, it lasted only until our destroyers, troops, and aircraft were deployed in the Atlantic and in Florida. Thereafter, while we held firm, Khrushchev had no alternative except to turn his ships around and stop construction at the missile sites.

Such "lessons" offer comfort, but they share a flaw. It lies in the assumption that the Soviet rulers were at once cool calculators, reasoning from all the evidence at *our* disposal, and assured controllers, orchestrating every act of their bureaucracies. As Robert Kennedy informs us, this is an assumption that the President resisted. His resistance accounts for the "flap" at the White House.

What Kennedy appears to have believed is that Khrushchev might be a ruler somewhat like himself, beset by uncertainties in seeking evidence and weighing it, likely to misjudge its meaning in another country's context, susceptible to human imperfections of emotion and fatigue, plagued also by the bureaucratic imperfections of communication and control. Khrushchev's long message on Friday night, October 26, seems powerfully to have reinforced this presidential point of view, adding to White House concern about a third week of crisis. If the Russians held their course for a mere seventy-two hours, we would have to escalate a step, probably by bombing Cuban sites. In logic, they should then bomb Turkish sites. Then we…; then they…. The third step is what evidently haunted Kennedy. If Khrushchev's capability to calculate and to control was something like his own, then neither's might suffice to guide them both through that third step without holocaust.

## New Checks and Balances

In warmaking, the Constitution contemplated enforced collaboration between the President and his fellow politicians on Capitol Hill. In practice, as the missile crisis illustrates, a strong role for Congress is by no means assured. This does not mean, however, that Presidents act in isolation. Any modern President stands at the center of a watchful circle with whose members he cannot help but consult. Today, indeed, he is more dependent on Executive officials for advice as well as execution than our Constitution makers could have anticipated two centuries ago.

New checks and balances replace the old. There is, however, one extraordinary difference: the old circle was supposedly comprised of men who owed their places to elections, who themselves had experienced the risks of nomination and electioneering. Political